he would allow access to all roads, to which he replied ‘Of course’. A compromise was now arrived at by which a new road was constructed that allowed free movement along three sides of the temple approaches but not on the fourth. This was enough for Gandhi, who moved on to greater things, having established that *satyagraha* could serve as a potent weapon in the national freedom struggle.




Two Keralan reformers. (Above, left) Koyapalli Kelappan. (Above, right) Velathu Lakshmikutty, who led protests against a temple ban in 1952.

However, there still remained the equally hurtful issue of the ban on temple entry. This came to a head at the Guruvayur satyagraha of 1931, which was directed at the Krishna temple of Guruvayur near Thrissur in what was then British Malabar, maintained by Cennas Nambudiris, supported by Nair Panikkars but under the authority of the Zamorin of Calicut. But now the protests were headed by a group of Nairs led by Koyapalli Kelappan, first president of the Nair Service Society, which was formed in 1914 both to protect the interests of Nairs and to improve their